

MANUAL HANDLING TOOLBOX TALK

Assess loads correctly, lift safely and prevent unnecessary strain.

5-7 MINUTES

OBJECTIVE

Prevent back, shoulder, hand and musculoskeletal injuries during manual handling by assessing the load, work area and individual capacity before starting.

TOPIC EXPLANATION

- Manual handling includes lifting, lowering, carrying, pushing, pulling, holding and repetitive movements.
- The load's shape, grip points, stability, travel distance and effect on visibility must be considered, not only its weight.
- Use forklifts, pallet trucks, cranes, trolleys or other mechanical aids whenever reasonably practicable.
- Workers must not be pressured to lift a load that cannot be handled safely.

REALISTIC SITE SCENARIO

- A worker attempts to lift an irregular 30-kilogram equipment part from the floor without assistance.
- The load has poor grip points and materials obstruct the carrying route.
- The worker twists while lifting and suffers a back injury.

REMEMBER

Assess the load and centre of gravity before lifting. • Keep a stable stance and hold the load close to your body. • Bend your knees instead of bending from the waist. • Turn with your feet instead of twisting your torso. • Asking for assistance is the correct safety decision.

MANUAL HANDLING TOOLBOX TALK

Use before lifting, carrying, pushing, pulling or manually positioning loads.

5-7 MINUTES

MAIN HAZARDS

- Back and spinal injuries
- Muscle strains and sprains
- Hand and finger trapping
- Dropped loads
- Slips, trips and falls
- Restricted visibility
- Repetitive strain injuries

KEY CONTROLS

- Assess the load's weight, size, shape and grip points.
- Use mechanical lifting and transport equipment wherever possible.
- Inspect and clear the carrying route before starting.
- Use team lifting where required and appoint one person to coordinate.
- Keep the load close to the body and avoid sudden movements.
- Wear suitable gloves and safety footwear.
- Do not lift loads beyond your safe capacity or control.

SUPERVISOR SCRIPT

Which manual-handling tasks create the most difficulty today? • What mechanical aids are available in our work area? • Are there obstacles along the planned carrying route? • Which tasks must not be completed by one person?

QUESTIONS FOR THE TEAM

- Can you safely control this load alone?
- Where is the load's centre of gravity?
- Is the carrying route clear?
- Is mechanical assistance or a second worker required?
- Does the load restrict your view?

VERIFY BEFORE STARTING

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ The load and handling method have been | ☐ The carrying route is clear. |
| ☐ Required mechanical aids are available. | ☐ Team-lifting roles are agreed where required. |
| ☐ Suitable PPE is being used. | |

ATTENDANCE AND RECORD

MANUAL HANDLING TOOLBOX TALK

Date

Site / Area

Supervisor

Participants

Signature

Name	Position	Signature	
1			
2			
3			
4			
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